CHIMERA EXECUTION PLAYBOOK

Chimera APP for Dummies

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BEGINNER WALKTHROUGH

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Chimera Beginner Walkthrough + Playbook

Your complete, step-by-step guide to connecting TradingView, understanding Chimera signals, running safe paper tests, and building a repeatable trading process — from first click to daily review.

Important: This is educational and process guidance, not financial advice. No strategy guarantees profit. Always use strict risk limits and begin with paper trading before risking real capital.

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Chimera vs ICC vs Pure ICC

Before you touch a single button, it helps to understand **where Chimera fits** in the landscape of trading approaches. There are three broad styles you'll hear about — and each has a very different relationship with rules, flexibility, and accountability.

Pure ICC (Discretionary)

The trader interprets structure, liquidity, and timing concepts manually in real time. **Flexibility is high**, but consistency depends entirely on the trader's emotional state and memory. The main risk here is **impulse decisions** — you see what you want to see, and you click when you shouldn't.

ICC-Style Rules (Structured)

Same underlying concepts, but codified into repeatable rules. You write down your criteria and follow them each session. **Consistency improves**, but there's still a risk of **rule drift** — gradually bending your own rules without noticing because nothing enforces them.

Chimera (Rules + Gate + Logs)

ICC-style logic combined with an objective bridge gate, execution auditing, and full signal logging. **Auditability is the highest** of any approach. The tradeoff is that overly strict filters can block valid trades — but that's adjustable, and far safer than the alternative.

Why Chimera Wins for Beginners

- **Fewer impulse trades** — the bridge can block weak entries before you act on emotion
- **Better consistency** — rules are codified in config files, not stored in your memory
- **Better review loop** — every webhook and signal is logged automatically
- **Better safety** — paper mode, kill-switches, and profile gates protect you while you learn

Beginner Takeaway

Pure discretionary trading can be powerful in experienced hands, but for someone just starting out, **consistency beats flexibility**. Chimera is designed to give you a repeatable process — not discretionary hero trades. Treat it as a **discipline framework**, and you'll build skills that compound over time.

The goal isn't to predict the market. The goal is to **execute a process** and then systematically improve it.

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Chimera Signal Flow (End-to-End)

Understanding the full signal pipeline is the single most important concept for any Chimera beginner. Every trade — or *non*-trade — follows the exact same four-step path. Memorize this flow, and you'll always know where to look when something goes right or wrong.

Step A: TradingView + Pine

Your Pine strategy detects a setup and determines directional intent: **LONG**, **SHORT**, or **FLAT**. This is the "setup question" — does the chart show a valid pattern?

Step B: Chimera Bridge

The bridge gate checks microstructure quality, profile rules, and guardrails. It asks: "Is this setup **good enough** to execute right now?" This is where weak entries get filtered.

Step C: Executor Decision

The executor renders a final verdict — **GO_LONG**, **GO_SHORT**, or **NO_TRADE** — and logs the full reason for the decision. Every pass and every block is recorded.

Step D: Paper Journal

Orders, state changes, and closed trades are written to your paper journal. This is your review dataset — the foundation for everything you improve.

> **Golden Rule:** If TradingView and Chimera do not agree → **NO TRADE**. Execute only when the strategy direction and the bridge decision are fully aligned. If they conflict, Chimera blocks or skips. Period.

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TradingView + Chimera Setup

Connecting TradingView to Chimera is simpler than it looks. You're essentially telling TradingView: "When your strategy fires an order, send a webhook message to Chimera's local server." Here's the exact beginner workflow, step by step.

1 Sign In to TradingView

Open your browser and navigate to **tradingview.com**. Sign into your account. This is your charting and strategy environment — Chimera does *not* replace or host the TradingView login. You always sign in on TradingView directly.

2 Open Your Chart

Load the **exact same symbol and timeframe** that Chimera is configured for (e.g., `MNQ1!` on the 5-minute chart, or `MGC1!`). Consistency here is critical — mismatches between TV and Chimera are the #1 beginner error.

3 Load & Verify Your Pine Strategy

Open the **Pine Editor**, paste or load your Chimera-aligned Pine strategy, and click **"Add to chart."** Verify that strategy order markers (arrows/labels) appear on your chart. If they don't, the script has an error or isn't compiled.

4 Start the Chimera Executor

In your terminal, run: `python run_chimera_executor.py --config config/config.yaml --host 127.0.0.1 --port 8787`. Then confirm the server is healthy by visiting or curling `http://127.0.0.1:8787/status`.

5 Create the TradingView Webhook Alert

Click **"Alert"** in TradingView. Set the condition to your strategy's order event. Set the Webhook URL to `http://127.0.0.1:8787/webhook/tradingview`. For paper mirroring, use `/webhook/tradingview/paper` instead. Chimera stores mirrored journal data in `data/tradingview_paper/`.

Webhook JSON fields: Your alert message should include: `symbol`, `action`, `price`, and `timestamp_utc`. Example: `{"symbol":"{{ticker}}","action":"{{strategy.order.action}}","price":"{{close}}","timestamp_utc":"{{timenow}}"}`

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Signals: TradingView vs Chimera

One of the most common points of confusion for beginners is understanding the **difference between a TradingView signal and a Chimera signal**. They are not the same thing, and learning to read their relationship is the key to disciplined execution.

TradingView Signal

This is a **setup intent** generated by your Pine strategy logic. It answers the question: *"Does the chart show a valid pattern right now?"* The output is directional — LONG, SHORT, or FLAT. Think of it as a **proposal**.

Chimera Signal / Gate

This is an **execution-quality decision** made by the bridge profile and guardrails. It answers the question: *"Is this setup good enough to act on right now?"* The output is GO_LONG, GO_SHORT, or NO_TRADE. Think of it as the **approval authority**.

Decision Matrix

TradingView Says	Chimera Says	Result	Action
LONG	GO_LONG	✅ Eligible	Execute
SHORT	GO_SHORT	✅ Eligible	Execute
LONG	GO_SHORT	❌ Conflict	Block / Skip
SHORT	GO_LONG	❌ Conflict	Block / Skip
Any	NO_TRADE	❌ Blocked	Block / Skip

> **Beginner rule:** If in doubt, **skip**. Missing a trade is always cheaper than forcing a bad one. Discipline compounds. Losses from forced trades compound too — in the wrong direction.

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Pine Strategy Explained

You don't need to be a Pine Script expert to use Chimera, but understanding the **five building blocks** of a Chimera-aligned Pine strategy will help you know what's happening under the hood — and more importantly, what to tweak when something isn't working.

1

Context

Trend/Range regime detection. The strategy first identifies the current market environment. Is price trending directionally, or is it consolidating in a range? This context determines which type of entry logic is appropriate.

2

Trigger

Entry condition. Once the context is identified, the strategy watches for a specific pattern — a break, sweep, reclaim, or other signal — that qualifies as an entry. This is the "setup" that gets sent to Chimera via webhook.

3

Risk

Stop loss + take profit levels. Every entry must have predefined exit levels. The strategy calculates these based on structure, ATR, or fixed offsets. No entry should ever be placed without a clear invalidation point.

4

Sizing

Quantity rules. How many contracts or shares per trade? For beginners, this should always be **fixed size in paper mode**. Dynamic sizing comes later, after you've proven consistent execution over dozens of trades.

5

Output

Alerts and webhook payloads. The strategy generates the order actions (LONG/SHORT/FLAT) that TradingView sends to Chimera. This is the handoff point — where your chart analysis becomes an actionable signal.

Beginner Defaults

One symbol • One timeframe • One risk profile (strict or balanced) • Fixed size in paper mode

Optimization Rule

Change only **one variable at a time**. If you change two things and results improve, you won't know which change mattered.

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Backtest Lab Workflow

The Backtest Lab is where you **validate behavior before risking real capital**. Think of it as a flight simulator for your trading strategy — you want to crash here, not in the live market. Every strategy change should go through this lab before it touches even paper trading.

Running a Backtest

From your project directory, run a profile against a dataset:

```
venv/bin/python scripts/run_backtest_profile.py \
  --profile combined_trend_ict_range \
  --dataset mixed_50k
```

Results are saved to: `results/backtests/<profile>/<dataset>_<timestamp>/`

Available Profiles

- `trend_only` — Pure trending market conditions
- `range_preserved` — Sideways, range-bound tape
- `ict_asian_sweep` — Asian session liquidity sweeps
- `ict_asian_sweep_inverted` — Inverted sweep variant
- `combined_trend_ict_range` — Mixed conditions (recommended for beginners)

What to Review First

1. **Total trades** — enough sample size?
2. **Win rate** — directional accuracy
3. **Profit factor** — gross profit ÷ gross loss
4. **Max drawdown** — worst peak-to-trough decline
5. **Average trade quality** — consistency per trade

Promotion Gate: Paper → Bigger Size

You should only increase position size (or move toward live trading) when you've met **all four** of these criteria across multiple recent runs:

60+

Minimum Trades

Enough sample size to trust the results statistically

≥1.30

Profit Factor

Your gross profits must exceed gross losses by at least 30%

≤4%

Max Drawdown

Peak-to-trough decline must stay controlled and manageable

3+

Stable Windows

Consistent results across multiple recent backtest runs, not just one

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Daily Checklist (Beginner SOP)

Trading is a process, not an event. The most successful Chimera users treat every session like a professional shift: there's a **pre-flight check**, an **in-session protocol**, and a **post-session review**. Follow this Standard Operating Procedure every single day — no exceptions, no shortcuts.

Before Session

- Start Chimera app (bridge writing ON)
- Start the executor server
- Confirm `/status` endpoint returns healthy
- Confirm TradingView alert is active and pointing to the correct webhook URL
- Verify symbol and timeframe match between TV and Chimera

During Session

- Take **only aligned signals** — both engines must agree
- Respect your daily loss limit and max trade count
- Do **not** switch profiles mid-emotion
- No revenge sizing — ever
- If you feel frustrated or euphoric, step away

After Session

- Review blocked vs. executed signals in the log
- Read journal files: `data/<session>/closed_trades.csv`
- Mark any rule violations honestly
- Decide **one specific improvement** for the next day
- Log that improvement commitment in your notes

Why "one improvement" matters: Trying to fix everything at once leads to changing nothing. A single, focused process improvement per session compounds into massive growth over weeks and months. Write it down. Hold yourself accountable.

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Troubleshooting Quick Fixes

Things will break. That's normal — especially when you're setting up webhooks, local servers, and multi-system coordination for the first time. The good news is that **most beginner issues fall into three categories**, and the fixes are straightforward. Here's your troubleshooting playbook.

🔴 Problem: No Fills Recorded

Your TradingView alert fired, but Chimera shows no orders or closed trades. This almost always means the signal never reached the executor.

- **Check the executor is running** — verify it's listening on `127.0.0.1:8787` by hitting the `/status` endpoint
- **Check the alert webhook URL** — a typo in the URL (wrong port, missing path) is the most common cause
- **Check the JSON fields** — ensure your alert message includes `symbol`, `action`, `price`, and `timestamp_utc` with the correct TradingView placeholders
- **Check firewall settings** — some systems block localhost webhook connections by default

🟡 Problem: Too Many Blocked Trades

Chimera is blocking most signals and you're barely getting any fills. This feels frustrating, but it's actually the system doing its job — it just might be calibrated too tightly for current conditions.

- **You may be on a strict profile** in a low-confidence, choppy market — this is expected behavior
- **Collect a sample first** — track 20+ blocked signals before deciding to adjust. Don't loosen filters after 3 blocks
- **Review the block reasons** in the logs — are they microstructure failures, profile mismatches, or something else?
- **Consider switching to a balanced profile** only after evidence supports the change

🔵 Problem: TV Chart and Chimera Feel Out of Sync

Your TradingView chart shows one thing, but Chimera seems to be responding to something different. This is almost always a configuration mismatch.

- **Check symbol match** — are you charting `MNQ1!` but Chimera is configured for `NQ1!`?
- **Check timeframe match** — a 5-minute chart strategy won't align with a 15-minute Chimera profile
- **Check action mapping** — verify LONG/SHORT/FLAT labels are consistent between Pine output and Chimera input
- **Check clock/timezone consistency** — TradingView uses exchange time by default; Chimera may use UTC

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FINAL PLAYBOOK

Your Daily Execution Order

Every session, every day, follow this sequence. No improvisation. No shortcuts. The power of Chimera isn't in prediction — it's in **process**.

01

Prepare Your System

Start Chimera, start the executor, verify health, confirm TradingView alert is active and aimed at the right webhook. No session begins until the infrastructure is confirmed green.

02

Validate Signal Alignment

Watch for signals where TradingView and Chimera fully agree on direction. If they conflict, do nothing. Alignment is non-negotiable.

03

Execute Only When Both Engines Agree

When you get a green light from both systems, take the trade. This is the only scenario where action is appropriate. Everything else is a skip.

04

Respect Your Risk Limits

Daily loss cap. Max trade count. Fixed sizing. These aren't suggestions — they're the guardrails that keep you in the game long enough to improve.

05

Review Logs and Improve Your Process

After every session, read the journal. Identify one thing to improve. Write it down. Execute it tomorrow. This is how compounding works in skill development.

> **Chimera wins for beginners when you treat it as a rules engine, not a prediction machine.** Let it reduce bad decisions. Let the process do the heavy lifting. Your job is to show up prepared, follow the system, and improve 1% every day.

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